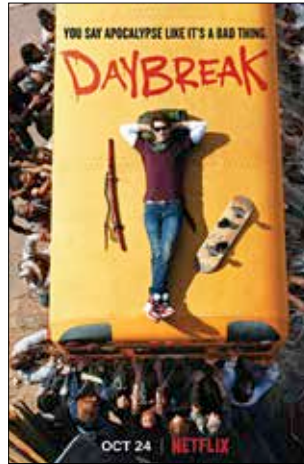


TV SERIES

Daybreak

★★★★☆ | Daybreak narrowly avoids being labelled as your typical high-school comedy / drama show with its unique setting; it's based in a post-apocalyptic Glendale California. The show follows the protagonist around the ravaged town as he skirts along the borders of the different cliques that have formed as a result of the world having practically no adults left living alive (they've been turned into Zombies, you see). Naturally, kids with similar interests have banded together and carved out their own territories which they defend to the death. Yes, the show has gratuitous levels of violence that's characterised by the nonchalance that only kids can muster. Minor infractions are solved in a gory manner that makes movies such as Mad Max seem like child's play. The central plot revolves around our protagonist learning that the love of his life has probably survived the nuclear apocalypse and is hiding somewhere in the town. Think of Daybreak as Scott Pilgrim meets Battle Royale meets Mad Max meets *insert Zombie movie name here* meets Kick-Ass. Production quality is quite high and the show uses the fourth-wall breaking approach with reckless abandon. Think of it as something you'd watch if you had absolutely nothing else to do. There isn't enough to keep you wanting for more.



MOVIE

Star Wars: The Rise of Skywalker

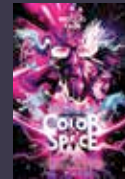
★★★★☆ | Forty two years in the making, the Star Wars saga is one of the must-see fantasy movies that any sci-fi fan will agree to. That is, until they watch Star Wars: The Rise of Skywalker. Many would agree that it should have been limited to the original trilogy. Once episodes 1-3 came out, we were skeptical at first but later on, we found the storyline to be palatable despite Hayden Christenson's abysmal acting skills and Lucas' desire to demystify the force. Over these forty two years, the Star Wars universe has massively expanded to include hundreds of short stories, novels, comics, TV shows, movies and what not. However, the main storyline that has remained sacrosanct was from the movies. So you can imagine the sheer pressure on JJ Abrams to tie it all up and put an end to the Skywalker saga without disappointing fans around the world. Unfortunately, JJ focused all his attention on fan service and completely dropped the ball on the story. While there is a thin plotline, it has been relegated to the compactor in favour of slipping in as many easter eggs, cameos and anything else you can think of. Imagine someone made a list of all the things that they'd like to see in this final movie and the producers actually made that very thing. The scenes transition haphazardly and that characters literally spell out exactly what's going to happen. Every scene screams out at the audience as if they were the dumbest beings on the planet and needed remedial treatment from the get go. Rarely do you see a movie with this level of potential being rendered into absolute rubbish. It's certainly worth a watch to see how it all ends but be prepared to be depressed at the end of it.



UP AND COMING

MOVIE

Color Out of Space



This one is unlikely to release in India, so will be difficult to get hold of, but The Colour out of Space is a promising mixture of b-grade pulp sci fi movies of the 50s and Lovecraftian horror. An alien organism infects the minds of a small town, in a technicolour nightmare.

Release date: January 24, 2020

BOOK

The Conference of the Birds



This novel series evolved from a picture book of spooky Victoriana, and just keeps getting better with every release.

This is the fifth book in the Miss Peregrine's Peculiar Children series by Ransom Riggs, and is probably going to be worth it just for the vernacular photographs.

Release date: January 14, 2020

TV SHOW

Star Trek: Picard



This TV series is a sequel to the Star Trek (2009) and Star Trek Nemesis (2002) films. Picard is struggling with the loss

of Data as well as the destruction of the planet of Romulus, even twenty years after these events. This is a short, four episode mini series.

Release date: January 23, 2020